Qubit Chat: A Controlled Evaluation of Grover-Inspired Reranking for Document Retrieval

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***Abstract*—Selecting useful retrieval evidence requires balancing relevance with repeated information. We evaluate L6-guided Grover Adaptive Search as document-set selection after classical dense and lexical retrieval. A cross-encoder supplies relevance scores, and a compact ideal simulator performs phase marking and amplitude amplification over improving subsets. The base policy selects eight of fifteen candidates. A constrained refinement expands the candidate pool, preserves the first five results, and searches for a less redundant three-document tail under neural-score constraints. Full tests cover scientific claims, nutrition-related retrieval, and financial questions. FiQA currently uses the earlier base configuration. The reported full-test normalized discounted cumulative gain at rank five is 0.6878 on SciFact, 0.3689 on NFCorpus, 0.3575 on FiQA. SciFact redundancy falls 3.21 percent relative to matched base selection. NFCorpus redundancy falls 2.63 percent relative to matched base selection. Matched classical refiners attain the same aggregate quality on those follow-up tests, and the extra neural scoring increases complete pipeline latency. We provide paired query statistics, classical and neural controls, independent metric checks, oracle accounting, and mathematical preservation guarantees. These results characterize a relevance–redundancy tradeoff without establishing physical quantum acceleration, lower monetary cost, or improved generated answers.**

***Index Terms*—Grover Adaptive Search, document retrieval, cross-encoder, evidence selection, redundancy.**

I. Introduction

Retrieval-augmented systems retrieve documents before producing an answer [1]. Under a limited evidence budget, near-duplicate passages can displace evidence about other aspects of a question. Independent document scores do not model these relationships. Joint set selection must therefore be compared with strong relevance models and classical optimizers of the same objective.

Grover search reduces oracle queries under a specified access model [2], [3]. It does not remove classical embedding, retrieval, state preparation, or reversible computation costs. In a threshold-marking reranker, equally marked documents have symmetric ideal amplification. Their measurement probabilities therefore do not themselves provide a graded relevance ordering. Transforming those probabilities into ranking scores requires controls for both threshold fallback and relevance distortion.

We retain that original policy as a legacy comparator and use Grover Adaptive Search (GAS) to search document subsets instead [4]. A neural cross-encoder supplies relevance evidence, while document embeddings measure redundancy. An earlier base policy jointly optimizes relevance and redundancy over fifteen candidates. The follow-up refinement protects its five highest-ranked outputs, expands the available tail candidates, and minimizes redundancy subject to neural-score constraints. Grover amplification affects the sampled subset; it is not substituted for a learned relevance score.

We ask whether constrained selection reduces redundancy while preserving the ranking prefix and limiting recall loss, how it compares with classical and neural controls, and what simulation resources it requires. The contribution is an evaluated retrieval formulation and reproducible accounting, rather than a new quantum search algorithm. Embedding similarity remains a proxy, not a duplicate percentage, judged coverage score, or answer-quality measure.

II. Related Work

Amplitude amplification counts oracle queries separately from construction and execution costs [2], [3]. Unknown marked-state counts motivate randomized schedules [5]; minimum finding adapts incumbent thresholds [6]. Gilliam, Woerner, and Gonciulea formulate constrained polynomial GAS with arithmetic oracles [4]. Our compact simulator implements ideal subset-basis phase and reflection operations; it does not realize all decision, arithmetic, and constraint registers on a quantum device.

Fixed-cardinality selection can be represented with fixed-weight bit strings. Dicke-state constructions show that such states need not always require arbitrary dense state synthesis [7]. However, a preparation method's theoretical circuit bound cannot be assigned to an implementation that does not execute it. Data access, arithmetic, and constraint checks remain central to interpreting quantum claims [8].

Maximal marginal relevance (MMR) balances relevance with novelty relative to previously selected documents [9]. Reciprocal-rank fusion (RRF) combines retrieval lists [10], and BM25 supplies lexical relevance [11]. Exact and greedy

TABLE I
DATASET COUNTS AND FROZEN BASE LEXICAL/DIVERSITY WEIGHTS.

Dataset	Parents	Dev.	Test	β	λ
SciFact	5,183	161	300	0.25	0.000
NFCorpus	3,633	324	323	0.50	0.050
FiQA	57,638	500	648	0.00	0.025

controls distinguish an objective's value from a search mechanism's value. Our matched refinement controls share the expanded candidates, fixed prefix, score constraints, and redundancy definition.

Sentence encoders provide reusable dense vectors [12]; cross-encoders jointly encode a query and passage to estimate relevance [13]. The `all-MiniLM-L6-v2` embedding model and `ms-marco-MiniLM-L6-v2` cross-encoder have different roles and training objectives [14]–[16]. "MS MARCO" denotes the latter's passage-ranking training task. BEIR supplies heterogeneous collections for testing retrieval across domains [17].

Task-specific decision pipelines also appear in blockchain mining: trust scoring [18], [19], VIKOR-based ranking [20], reputation and consensus mechanisms [21], [22], and miner selection or classification [23], [24]. Other application studies examine multimodal waste detection [25], smart-contract repair [26], financial-fraud detection [27], plant-disease recognition [28], traffic forecasting [29], and obscured-fruit classification [30]. These studies provide application context; their tasks and reported results are separate from our document-retrieval evaluation.

III. DATA AND EXPERIMENTAL PROTOCOL

A. Datasets and representations

Official BEIR SciFact, NFCorpus, and FiQA-2018 cover scientific claims, nutrition-related retrieval, and financial questions [31]–[33]. Table I reports parent-document and judged-query counts. Every positively judged official test query is included. Input checksums, query/document references, and development/test ID separation are verified. The larger FiQA collection extends corpus and domain coverage; it does not enlarge the quantum pool to the corpus size.

Dense representations use the pinned encoder `sentence-transformers/all-MiniLM-L6-v2`, revision `1110a243...529b4d41`, with 384-dimensional normalized vectors. Text uses Unicode NFKC and whitespace normalization. Full tokenizer offsets are obtained with padding and truncation disabled, including for the first document. Documents use at most 190 WordPiece content tokens per chunk with a step of 158; two special tokens yield at most 192 model-input tokens. Parent relevance is maximum query cosine over chunks. The representative passage is the maximizing original chunk, with the lowest chunk index breaking exact ties. Methods share parent IDs and representative passages for a given pool.

Queries are checked against the 190-content-token limit. Cross-encoder pairs are checked against 512 tokens without silent truncation. The relevance model is `cross-encoder/ms-marco-MiniLM-L6-v2`, revision `233902d2...bee0a`; the L2 control uses revision `1b5cd67b...9b787`. Full revisions and model-file hashes are retained in provenance. No test judgments enter retrieval, neural inference, or selection.

B. Development choices and follow-up protocol

SciFact development is a deterministic 20% subset of official training queries; NFCorpus and FiQA use official development splits. The base lexical grid is $\beta \in \{0, 0.25, 0.5\}$, and its diversity grid is $\lambda \in \{0, 0.01, 0.025, 0.05\}$. All stochastic settings use seeds 0–4. Eligibility requires development mean nDCG@5 and Recall@8 to equal or exceed the same-shortlist L6-only baseline within 10^{-12}. Eligible settings prefer higher nDCG, higher recall, lower redundancy, smaller penalty, and smaller lexical weight, in that order. Zero penalty is retained when it wins.

L6 MMR is independently tuned over $\{0, 0.1, 0.25, 0.5, 0.75, 1\}$, prioritizing nDCG, recall, lower redundancy, and smaller weight. Its selected weight is zero on these collections. This is a relevance-prioritizing development choice, not the entire MMR tradeoff frontier. Cosine-guided controls retain separate frozen development settings. Legacy thresholds $\{0.3, 0.5, 0.7\}$ are selected on development nDCG@5 using matched classical sampling; ties prefer 0.5, then 0.3, then 0.7.

Refinement uses deterministic 100-query training confirmation with namespace `accuracy-v3-confirmation-v1`, excluding historical development, test, and pilot IDs. Its gate requires unchanged mean nDCG@5, at least 98% of matched base mean Recall@8, and strictly lower mean redundancy. The recall limit is relative, not two absolute percentage points. These mean gates do not prove statistical noninferiority. NFCorpus's 100-query training confirmation failed the recall gate (-2.1561% relative change). Full-test collection nevertheless proceeded as an explicitly recorded protocol exception with unchanged ranking parameters; its subsequent test result does not erase that failure.

SciFact and NFCorpus include protected-prefix refinement; FiQA reports the earlier fifteen-candidate configuration. Matched optimizers use the corresponding configuration; these are distinct policies within the L6-guided GAS family. The newer official tests are follow-up evaluations: earlier test outcomes had already informed method development. They are not an untouched holdout for the redesigned policy. The recorded parameters are not retuned against follow-up judgments. Training-confirmation outcomes are not substituted for full-test effectiveness.

C. Comparators, metrics, and timing

We retain twenty original methods and add seven expanded-pool comparisons where refinement is evaluated. Controls include cosine, BM25/dense RRF with rank constant 60, native

cosine and L6 MMR, cosine-guided GAS, L6-only ranking, base L6-guided GAS, greedy/exact optimizers, random search, legacy Grover, and L2/L6 cross-encoders. Dense-fifteen and dense-sixty-four neural controls return eight in cross-encoder order. Their pools differ from hybrid-fifteen L6-only and the expanded union. Comparisons characterize complete policies, not isolated search substitutions.

The seven expanded-pool methods are constrained GAS, local-swap greedy, exact float, exact quantized, matched random search, global union-L6, and protected-prefix union-L6. Matched refiners inherit each seed's baseline prefix. Random refinement draws $\max(1, 2q)$ uniform subsets, where q is that seed's actual refinement phase count, plus its initial incumbent. This matches a declared objective-access allowance, not exhaustive simulator work. Exact controls independently enumerate their objectives; GAS receives neither their optimum nor marked-state counts.

Metrics are nDCG@5, Recall@8, and redundancy; nDCG@8 diagnoses changes below the protected prefix. nDCG uses linear gains and logarithmic discount [34], checked against NIST `trec_eval` [35]. Five seed values are averaged within each query, then across queries; seeds are not independent queries. Complete method exports accompany the compact tables.

The host is an Intel Core i7-1355U, 12 logical CPUs, approximately 15.3 GiB RAM, Linux, and Python 3.12.3. Processes use two compute threads. Packages include NumPy 1.26.4, SciPy 1.13.1, PyTorch 2.12.0+cpu, Transformers 4.57.6, Sentence Transformers 3.4.1, Qiskit 0.46.0 [36], and Aer 0.13.3. Data/model restore and artificial-query warm-up are separate. Shared-host load and session boundaries are retained; the machine is not a dedicated latency laboratory.

Online latency composes query encoding, dense retrieval, representative features, applicable lexical processing, original/additional neural inference, baseline selection, and refinement. Shared upstream measurements are charged to each applicable policy. Selector latency excludes retrieval/inference but includes objective preparation and bookkeeping. Combined selector percentiles add actual baseline and refinement times per request before aggregation. P95 is over seeded requests, never divided by five. Across-session differences are not matched speed experiments.

IV. L6-Guided Grover Set Selection

A. Retrieval and base objective

Let $c_i \in [-1, 1]$ be parent query cosine among dense top 64 and $b_i \geq 0$ its BM25 score. The reproduced hybrid score is

$$h_i = (1-\beta)\frac{1+c_i}{1+\max_j c_j} + \beta\frac{b_i}{\max_j b_j}. \tag{1}$$

If lexical scores are negligible, use only the dense term. If its denominator is negligible, use $(1 + c_i)/2$. Negligibility uses tolerance 10^{-12}. Hybrid top fifteen is sorted by score and document ID. Keep raw logits z_i, cosine, embeddings, and normalized relevance separate. Within the original fifteen,

$$r_i = \frac{z_i - \min_j z_j}{\max_j z_j - \min_j z_j}, \tag{2}$$

with $r_i = 0.5$ for negligible range. Negative logits are valid.

For normalized representative vectors v_i, define $d_{ij} = \mathrm{clip}(v_i^\top v_j, 0, 1)$. For $|S| = k = 8$,

$$\mathcal{R}(S) = \binom{k}{2}^{-1} \sum_{\{i,j\}\subset S} d_{ij}, \tag{3}$$

$$U(S) = k^{-1}\sum_{i\in S} r_i - \lambda\mathcal{R}(S). \tag{4}$$

The base uses eight-bit coefficients, $a = 255$, and energy

$$q_i = \mathrm{round}(ar_i), \quad q_{ij} = \mathrm{round}\left(\frac{2a\lambda}{k-1}d_{ij}\right), \tag{5}$$

$$E_b(S) = -\sum_{i\in S} q_i + \sum_{\{i,j\}\subset S} q_{ij}. \tag{6}$$

Rounding is ties-to-even. Raw-L6 top eight initializes the incumbent; raw L6 descending with document-ID ties determines final order. Summing coefficient errors gives, for each fixed set,

$$\left|\frac{-E_b(S)}{ak} - U(S)\right| \leq \frac{k+1}{4a}. \tag{7}$$

This bounds approximation, not retrieval accuracy. At zero penalty the top-L6 incumbent maximizes relevance and is retained; quantization does not justify arbitrary equal-energy reordering.

B. Protected-prefix refinement

Figure 1 shows how the base feeds refinement. Form union C of hybrid top-fifteen lists at $\beta = 0, 0.25, 0.5$, within the same dense top 64. It has at most 45 documents. Score the original shortlist first and preserve its exact logits; score only additional candidates afterward. This prevents neural batching changes from altering the base result.

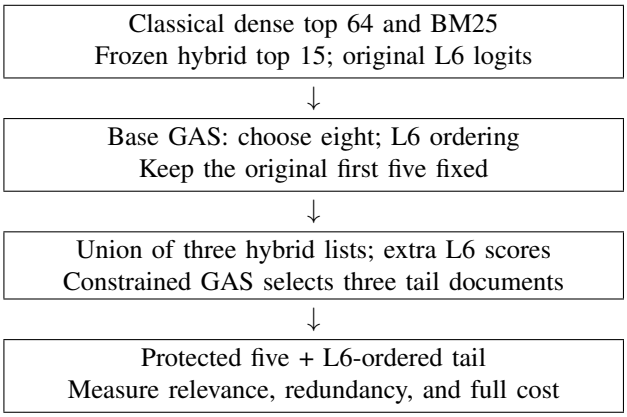


Fig. 1. Base selection and protected-prefix refinement. The base configuration returns after the second stage; refinement cost includes every applicable upstream stage.

For each seed, let base ranking be $(s_1, \ldots, s_8)$, fixed prefix $H = (s_1, \ldots, s_5)$, and original tail T_0. Search $T \subseteq C \setminus H$, $|T| = 3$. Ascending sorted tail logits must satisfy

$$z_{(j)}(T) \geq z_{(j)}(T_0) - \varepsilon, \quad j = 1, 2, 3, \quad \varepsilon = 10^{-12}. \tag{8}$$

Candidates below the smallest original-tail logit minus ε can safely be discarded: they cannot occupy even the lowest position. Let M be the remaining tail-pool size. Constraint (8) is equivalent to requiring at least $4 - j$ tail scores above each fixed bound $z_{(j)}(T_0) - \varepsilon$, using inclusive comparisons. A count violation identifies a sorted position below its bound, and meeting every count constraint places each position at or above its bound. This also handles tied scores.

Minimize $\mathcal{R}(H \cup T)$, including prefix–prefix, prefix–tail, and tail–tail pairs. The fixed prefix term is constant but remains in reported redundancy. With $a = 2^{16} - 1$, refinement energy is

$$E_r(H \cup T) = \sum_{\{i,j\} \subset H \cup T} \operatorname{round}(a d_{ij}). \tag{9}$$

Mark valid states with strictly lower integer energy than the incumbent. Accept a measured update only if true redundancy also decreases by more than ε. Output the original prefix followed by the new tail in raw-L6 order. This deliberately differs from a global L6 sort when an added document scores above a protected one.

C. Guarantees and counterexample

Prefix preservation. With fixed judgments, nDCG@5 depends only on the first five IDs and their order. Preserving them keeps DCG@5 and its ideal denominator identical. Per-query nDCG@5 and its seed/query means are therefore unchanged by construction. This is not an empirical accuracy gain uniquely due to Grover search; nDCG@8 and Recall@8 can change.

Feasibility and redundancy. The unchanged T_0 satisfies (8), survives the prefilter, and appears in the size-three basis. It supplies eight unique outputs even at budget exhaustion or when no improvement is sampled. Every accepted update strictly lowers true redundancy. Induction therefore gives final redundancy no greater than base redundancy. Strict improvement is not guaranteed per query; a trivial basis or an optimum can retain the original set.

Quantization bound. Each of the 28 rounded pair coefficients differs from its unrounded value by at most $1/2$. Thus

$$\left| \frac{E_r(S)}{28a} - \mathcal{R}(S) \right| \leq \frac{1}{2a}. \tag{10}$$

Applying this twice bounds exact quantized-optimizer redundancy regret by $1/a$ relative to the exact float optimizer over the same admissible domain. It does not prove budget-limited GAS reaches that optimizer. At sixteen bits the per-set bound is approximately 7.63×10^{-6}; model error is not bounded by coefficient precision.

Recall counterexample. Replacing a relevant original-tail document by an irrelevant but higher-L6-scoring document can satisfy (8) while reducing recall. Therefore score dominance does not guarantee true relevance. Empirical recall gates and paired uncertainty remain necessary; neither an unchanged prefix nor higher logits establish overall noninferiority.

D. Amplitude amplification and budgets

The base has $\binom{15}{8} = 6{,}435$ cardinality-feasible subsets. Refinement has $F = \binom{M}{3}$ size-three subsets after score prefiltering, including subsets later failing (8). Only valid improving states are marked. For $|u\rangle = F^{-1/2} \sum_x |x\rangle$, one step is

$$G = (2|u\rangle\langle u| - I) O_\tau, \tag{11}$$

$$O_\tau |x\rangle = (-1)^{[\mathrm{valid}(x) \wedge E(x) < \tau]} |x\rangle. \tag{12}$$

The simulator explicitly flips marked amplitudes and reflects amplitudes about their post-oracle mean. These operations preserve the norm; measurement samples squared amplitudes. This is ideal amplitude amplification executed classically, not execution on quantum hardware.

Each stage begins with its incumbent and window $w = 1$. A trial draws an integer from zero through $\lceil w \rceil - 1$, limited by remaining phase calls, prepares the uniform state, applies that many steps, and measures. Strict improvement resets w; otherwise it grows by 1.2, capped at $\sqrt{F}$. Each stage allows 64 phase calls, 32 trials, or a cooperative 15-second limit per seed. Baseline and refinement budgets are separate: a refined request can use up to 128 phase calls. The controller receives no optimum or marked-state count. Trivial bases and every termination reason remain recorded.

V. Results and Interpretation

A. Effectiveness and controls

Table II gives reported L6-guided GAS results, and Table III provides retrieval/neural comparisons. SciFact preserved nDCG@5, changed mean Recall@8 by -0.93% relative, and reduced redundancy by 3.21% relative to the base GAS measured in the same run. Matched greedy and exact-float selection attained the same aggregate effectiveness and redundancy. NFCorpus preserved nDCG@5, changed mean Recall@8 by +1.95% relative, and reduced redundancy by 2.63% relative to the base GAS measured in the same run. Matched greedy and exact-float selection attained the same aggregate effectiveness and redundancy. FiQA's full-test base GAS reached 0.3575 nDCG@5 and 0.4341 Recall@8; its earlier configuration is not evidence for protected-prefix refinement there. In the protected setting, unchanged nDCG@5 follows from the prefix proof. Tail membership changes explain why reporting only that protected metric would conceal recall and nDCG@8 tradeoffs. The additional 648-query FiQA refinement follow-up preserved nDCG@5 and reduced redundancy by 8.23%, but Recall@8 fell 2.60% relative, exceeding the 2% allowance. It failed the frozen gate without retuning. The headline retains the disclosed earlier FiQA configuration.

The matched classical controls distinguish a selection objective's benefit from a search mechanism's benefit. Exact enumeration is practical because only three tail positions

TABLE II
REPORTED L6-GUIDED GAS FULL-TEST MEANS. RED. IS LOWER-IS-BETTER. SCIFACT AND NFCORPUS INCLUDE PROTECTED-PREFIX REFINEMENT; FIQA REPORTS THE EARLIER FIFTEEN-CANDIDATE CONFIGURATION. MATCHED OPTIMIZERS USE THE CORRESPONDING CONFIGURATION; THESE ARE DISTINCT POLICIES WITHIN THE L6-GUIDED GAS FAMILY.

Dataset	nDCG@5	nDCG@8	Recall@8	Red.↓
SciFact	0.687833	0.698173	0.801111	0.433636
NFCorpus	0.368865	0.346506	0.152997	0.431771
FiQA	0.357490	0.376939	0.434063	0.531244

change and score constraints often leave little freedom. Where greedy or exact selection matches GAS, improvement over base selection does not identify a Grover-specific gain. Global union-L6 and protected-prefix union-L6 controls, retained in the complete export, separate candidate expansion from prefix preservation. Some simpler controls attain lower redundancy with lower relevance; lower similarity alone is not universal policy superiority.

B. Paired statistics and recall

Table IV reports paired query differences. Confidence intervals use 10,000 paired bootstrap resamples with seed zero; sign-randomization tests use 10,000 permutations with seed one [37]. Differences within 10^{-12} are numerical ties. Protected-run Holm correction [38] covers nine comparators by four metrics per dataset, not just displayed rows. The base-only nDCG audit uses all six declared comparators.

Read recall changes with their intervals and query-level losses, not the mean gate alone. A positive mean change can coexist with harmed queries. An interval containing zero is not proof of equivalence or noninferiority [39]. Numerical averaging artifacts do not establish significance. Companion evidence retains all comparison families, query increase/decrease counts, and nDCG@8 diagnostics.

C. Latency and search outcomes

Table V charges all online stages. Expanded neural scoring increases complete latency against matched base GAS. Refinement-only milliseconds cannot be presented as the cost of the complete two-stage method. Reduced neural inference may cost less than dense-sixty-four reranking, but candidate opportunities differ. No universal speed advantage follows. Physical quantum runtime, monetary expenditure, and energy are not measured.

Table VI distinguishes optimization from retrieval quality: an optimum for constrained redundancy can lose recall. Trial/budget termination retains a valid incumbent. Same-set counts include trivial bases and unsuccessful improvement attempts, distinct from legacy no-marked fallback. Complete evidence retains phase calls, measured trials, accepted updates, optimum gaps, and termination counts, without excluding unsuccessful queries or seeds.

D. Threshold and resource evidence

Table VII summarizes recorded development threshold comparisons; no-marked rates use saved cosine candidates. No new rankings or test-driven threshold selection are performed. Lower thresholds reduce the no-marked condition but can change ranking behavior; the frozen development winner is 0.7. Subset search instead marks adaptive incumbent-energy improvement. It too may have no improving states, but safely returns its incumbent rather than assigning relevance from an empty marked set.

Compact simulation enumerates all F basis energies before amplification. These simulator evaluations are separate from initial/measured incumbent checks and logical phase calls. A phase call is recorded as two reversible objective calls for compute/uncompute; constraints and preparation would add physical work. Because the simulator already has every energy, a classical argmin can solve the encoded problem without amplitude simulation. Its phase budget cannot establish wall-clock acceleration over exact enumeration.

Table VIII records observed pool/basis sizes. Table IX reports measured resources for the new constrained oracle. Its classical coefficients encode head–tail and tail–tail similarity; reversible counters check cardinality and all three L6 thresholds. A signed improvement bit controls phase marking, followed by complete uncomputation. With signed width w and counter width $c = \lceil \log_2(M+1) \rceil$, total width is $M + w + 2c + 3$. Bounds include invalid-cardinality bit strings to prevent overflow.

The separate resource study freezes 32 training-confirmation queries per collection and five seeds. It varies eligible tail pools $M \in \{3, 5, 8, 12, 16, 20\}$ and pair precision $b \in \{4, 8, 12, 16\}$, retaining the baseline tail. All 80 completed native cells use at most two fixed seed-zero queries per available dataset/pool; unavailable sampled seed-zero sizes use explicitly artificial stress cases. Native simulation validated 6 complete iterations; 42 simulation attempts met the memory guard, and 0 whole circuit tasks met resource limits. Separate two-bit toy tests verify nontrivial five-decision marking and reflection. Full-iteration synthesis is restricted to $M \leq 8$, and native simulation to $M \leq 5$. All limits and complete precision results remain in the companion records. Native validation uses matrix-product-state simulation [40], whose resource cost depends on entanglement. Circuit tasks have 120-second and 2 GiB limits; synthesis uses optimization level one and transpiler seed zero. Small noiseless simulations compare independent expected states and check norm/workspace with a 10^{-8} probability tolerance. Compact selector time excludes its separate allocation-profile replay. Complex128 amplitudes occupy $16\binom{M}{3}$ bytes, while a full q-qubit statevector needs $16\,2^q$ bytes; neither is total-system memory. These measurements are not hardware-routing or quantum-speedup evidence.

VI. LIMITATIONS AND REPRODUCIBILITY

The classical top-64 and representative-chunk policies can exclude useful evidence before selection. Expansion stays within that pool; neural scoring supplies the relevance signal.

TABLE III
FULL-TEST COMPARISONS. N@5: NDCG@5; R@8: RECALL@8; RED.: CLIPPED-POSITIVE COSINE REDUNDANCY. GAS/MATCHED OPTIMIZERS FOLLOW TABLE II. BASE/L6-ONLY USE HYBRID FIFTEEN; DENSE-FIFTEEN CONTROLS USE A DIFFERENT SHORTLIST.

	SciFact			NFCorpus			FiQA		
Method	n@5	R@8	Red.	n@5	R@8	Red.	n@5	R@8	Red.
L6-guided GAS	0.6878	0.8011	0.4336	0.3689	0.1530	0.4318	0.3575	0.4341	0.5312
Base L6-guided GAS	0.6878	0.8086	0.4480	0.3689	0.1501	0.4434	0.3575	0.4341	0.5312
Cosine	0.6361	0.8111	0.4756	0.3181	0.1335	0.4398	0.3470	0.4153	0.5363
RRF	0.6677	0.8149	0.4727	0.3491	0.1394	0.4394	0.3509	0.4262	0.5327
Cosine-guided GAS	0.6311	0.7742	0.4490	0.3160	0.1235	0.3996	0.3452	0.4093	0.5215
Legacy Grover (64)	0.6364	0.8111	0.4756	0.3181	0.1334	0.4398	0.3458	0.4150	0.5363
L6 only (hybrid 15)	0.6878	0.8086	0.4480	0.3689	0.1500	0.4447	0.3575	0.4341	0.5313
L6 MMR (hybrid 15)	0.6878	0.8086	0.4480	0.3689	0.1500	0.4447	0.3575	0.4341	0.5313
Matched greedy	0.6878	0.8011	0.4336	0.3689	0.1530	0.4318	0.3575	0.4341	0.5311
Matched exact float	0.6878	0.8011	0.4336	0.3689	0.1530	0.4318	0.3575	0.4343	0.5309
Matched exact integer	0.6878	0.8011	0.4336	0.3689	0.1530	0.4318	0.3575	0.4341	0.5311
Matched random search	0.6878	0.8011	0.4338	0.3689	0.1531	0.4320	0.3575	0.4341	0.5313
L2 (dense 15)	0.6431	0.8049	0.4642	0.3509	0.1396	0.4486	0.3319	0.4217	0.5295
L6 (dense 15)	0.6790	0.8104	0.4655	0.3621	0.1423	0.4537	0.3575	0.4341	0.5313
L2 (dense 64)	0.6321	0.7916	0.4329	0.3481	0.1438	0.4468	0.2973	0.3918	0.4962
L6 (dense 64)	0.6815	0.8087	0.4379	0.3670	0.1437	0.4586	0.3535	0.4160	0.5033

TABLE IV
REPORTED GAS MINUS MATCHED BASE; *EARLIER FIQA BASE MINUS L6-ONLY. POINTWISE 95% CIS; FULL HOLM FAMILIES.

Dataset	Metric	Δ	95% paired CI	Raw p	Holm reject
SciFact	nDCG@5	+0.0000	[+0.0000, +0.0000]	1.0000	No
SciFact	nDCG@8	-0.0027	[-0.0081, +0.0023]	0.3043	No
SciFact	Recall@8	-0.0075	[-0.0242, +0.0075]	0.4565	No
SciFact	Redundancy	-0.0144	[-0.0168, -0.0122]	0.0001	Yes
NFCorpus	nDCG@5	+0.0000	[+0.0000, +0.0000]	1.0000	No
NFCorpus	nDCG@8	+0.0009	[-0.0025, +0.0045]	0.5897	No
NFCorpus	Recall@8	+0.0029	[+0.0004, +0.0062]	0.0369	No
NFCorpus	Redundancy	-0.0116	[-0.0140, -0.0094]	0.0001	Yes
FiQA	nDCG@5*	+0.0000	[+0.0000, +0.0000]	1.0000	No

A fixed quantum pool does not demonstrate quantum corpus search. The L2/L6 controls are concrete neural baselines, not every modern reranker. Development-selected zero-diversity MMR does not establish superiority over its full operating curve.

Protected nDCG@5 is relative to a particular baseline prefix, not a globally optimal ranking. The recall gate is empirical, individual queries can worsen, and the configuration coverage differs as stated in Table II. Test reuse and the confirmation exception limit confirmatory inference. Embedding similarity does not directly measure semantic duplication, complementary evidence, hallucination, or answer quality.

The primary simulator is noiseless and exhaustively prepares objectives. The separate native oracle compiles classical coefficients and has bounded preparation/simulation coverage. Efficient quantum data loading, physical-device routing, noise, monetary/energy models, and generated-answer experiments are not demonstrated. Shared-host variation and different candidate pools further limit speed comparisons.

Runs retain queries, models, data/code hashes, configurations, features, logits, timings, and per-seed/session traces. The exporter verifies provenance and recomputes saved metrics without modifying experiments. Original manifests bind NIST checks and corrected statistics. Central mappings support verified full-test replacement; companion records retain all controls, protocol exceptions, commands, and limitations.

VII. CONCLUSION

We evaluated L6-guided Grover Adaptive Search for evidence selection after dense and lexical retrieval. A cross-encoder scores relevance, while a compact classical simulator applies phase marking and amplitude amplification to document subsets. On SciFact and NFCorpus, refinement kept the first five results and reduced mean redundancy relative to matched base selection. Recall changes and their paired uncertainty remain explicit: score constraints do not guarantee judged relevance. FiQA's refinement follow-up failed the recall gate, so its headline uses the earlier configuration. Greedy and exact controls matched the protected method's quality, supporting the selection policy without establishing a unique Grover benefit. Native circuit measurements show resource growth, with limits on preparation, simulation, and memory. Classical retrieval, neural scoring, and simulation remain part of the full cost. These findings support a reproducible

TABLE V

COMPOSED ONLINE LATENCY IN MILLISECONDS PER SEEDED REQUEST. P50/P95 INCLUDE APPLICABLE RETRIEVAL, LEXICAL, NEURAL, AND SELECTION STAGES; LOADING/WARM-UP ARE SEPARATE. COMPARE WITHIN A DATASET/RUN, NOT SESSIONS AS MATCHED SPEED EXPERIMENTS.

	SciFact		NFCorpus		FiQA	
Method	P50	P95	P50	P95	P50	P95
L6-guided GAS	1406.5	1672.3	1146.8	1481.3	653.8	826.7
Base L6-guided GAS	963.2	1093.7	859.8	909.1	653.8	826.7
Cosine	33.3	48.3	24.5	32.9	79.9	98.5
RRF	61.6	94.9	31.0	44.5	225.3	328.3
Cosine-guided GAS	42.3	56.8	33.7	42.0	84.1	102.5
Legacy Grover (64)	38.2	313.6	25.2	281.6	84.3	231.9
L6 only (hybrid 15)	955.3	1085.4	851.9	901.4	650.0	821.1
L6 MMR (hybrid 15)	955.5	1085.7	852.1	901.6	650.1	821.3
Matched greedy	1405.4	1670.7	1145.5	1479.6	650.0	821.2
Matched exact float	1405.2	1670.6	1145.3	1479.3	651.2	822.5
Matched exact integer	1405.2	1670.6	1145.3	1479.3	651.1	822.4
Matched random search	1405.2	1670.6	1145.4	1479.3	651.9	824.8
L2 (dense 15)	348.0	403.0	310.5	331.5	238.9	294.6
L6 (dense 15)	915.8	1029.2	832.5	882.5	539.6	618.2
L2 (dense 64)	1374.7	1562.5	1242.5	1319.6	763.7	912.2
L6 (dense 64)	3799.0	4322.2	3460.8	3630.9	2037.9	2437.9

TABLE VI

REQUESTS AND MEAN BASE/REFINEMENT PHASE CALLS (BASE-ONLY SHOWS 0/BASE). HIT: EXACT FLOAT-REDUNDANCY OPTIMUM FOR REFINEMENT, EXACT INTEGER OPTIMUM FOR BASE-ONLY. SAME SET: RETAINED BASE MEMBERSHIP. S50/S95: COMBINED SELECTOR MS, EXCLUDING INFERENCE. LEGACY FALLBACK COUNTS HAVE THEIR OWN REQUEST DENOMINATOR.

Dataset	Requests	Base/refine calls	Hit	Same set	Legacy fallback	S50	S95
SciFact	1500	64.0/20.1	1.000	710	995/1500	9.66	10.67
NFCorpus	1615	63.9/17.8	1.000	957	1355/1615	9.49	11.02
FiQA	3240	0.0/64.0	0.994	–	2135/3240	3.95	4.54

TABLE VII

LEGACY DEVELOPMENT THRESHOLDS. N@5 USES STORED MATCHED-SAMPLING OUTCOMES; NONE IS THE PERCENTAGE OF SAVED QUERIES WITH NO COSINE CANDIDATE MEETING THE THRESHOLD. QUERY-LEVEL RATES DO NOT TREAT SEEDS AS INDEPENDENT OBSERVATIONS.

	SciFact dev.		NFCorpus dev.		FiQA dev.	
τ_c	n@5	None (%)	n@5	None (%)	n@5	None (%)
0.3	0.6627	0.0	0.3010	0.6	0.3514	0.0
0.5	0.6579	6.8	0.3011	31.8	0.3515	1.8
0.7	0.6656	67.1	0.3026	87.0	0.3516	69.4

TABLE VIII

OBSERVED PROTECTED-REFINEMENT RESOURCE RANGES OVER SEEDED REQUESTS. REFINE MS IS MEDIAN REFINEMENT-ONLY TIME, NOT ONLINE OR COMBINED SELECTION TIME.

Dataset	Union	Tail pool	Basis states	Refine ms
SciFact	16–28	3–10	1–120	1.95
NFCorpus	15–30	3–16	1–560	1.87

TABLE IX

MEASURED CONSTRAINED-ORACLE SYNTHESIS. SLASH-SEPARATED VALUES COMPARE 4/16-BIT COEFFICIENTS; INTERMEDIATE PRECISIONS ARE RETAINED IN COMPANION RECORDS. QUBITS INCLUDE ALL WORKSPACE; DEPTH/CX ARE OBSERVED MAXIMA IN THE UNRESTRICTED u, cx BASIS. STRESS DENOTES ARTIFICIAL DATA.

Tail	Source	Qubits	Depth	CX gates
3	real	19/31	1049/1865	992/2408
5	real	23/35	3891/5955	3256/6160
8	real	29/41	15067/20722	11684/18240
12	real	34/46	27570/41294	22068/36076
16	stress	39/51	61665/67687	43628/52212
20	stress	43/55	79769/96137	58220/75556

relevance–redundancy tradeoff without establishing quantum speed or monetary savings. Future work should assess device connectivity, noise, energy use, and generated-answer quality.

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